In: Combating Islamic Militancy and Terrorism…
Editor: Nikolas J. Koppel
ISBN: 978-1-60741-335-6
© 2010 Nova Science Publishers, Inc.

Chapter 3

ACTING ASSISTANT SECRETARY MULL'S WRITTEN TESTIMONY FOR THE HOUSE OVERSIGHT AND GOVERNMENT REFORM SUBCOMMITTEE ON NATIONAL SECURITY AND FOREIGN AFFAIRS

Nikolas J. Koppel

Mr. Chairman, distinguished members of the Subcommittee, thank you for asking me to testify today on the role the State Department plays in the "Oversight of Coalition Support Funds to Pakistan." I will focus my remarks on the procedures and standards that guide the Department in providing the Secretary of State's concurrence to the Department of Defense so that key cooperating nations in the War on Terror can be reimbursed through the Coalition Support Funds (CSF) program. In addition to providing support to 26 other nations, this program is an essential tool in enabling Pakistan to support War on Terror objectives and U.S. military operations.

The Bureau of Political-Military Affairs (PM), which I lead, serves as the principal liaison with the Department of Defense on policy issues, including security assistance, and on coordination of U.S. military-related activities with U.S. foreign policy implications. As such, the PM Bureau coordinates State Department positions and clearances for numerous Department of Defense programs that require the concurrence of the Secretary of State. Along with CSF, these programs include, but are not limited to, the Iraqi Security Forces Funds, the Afghan Security Forces Fund, and section 1206 train and equip programs.

The Department of State recognizes that CSF is not a foreign assistance program; rather, serves to reimburse cooperating countries for the support they provide to U.S. military operations. The legislation governing the use of CSF requires that the Department of Defense obtain the Secretary of State's concurrence prior to providing reimbursement. We understand the fundamental purpose of this concurrence is to ensure that payments made under this program are supportive of, and consistent with, U.S. foreign policy objectives for the recipient country, and that they will not adversely affect the balance of power in the region.

There are three initial steps in the clearance process:

Copyright © 2010. Nova Science Publishers, Incorporated. All rights reserved.

Combating Islamic Militancy and Terrorism in Pakistan's Border Region, Nova Science Publishers, Incorporated, 2010. ProQuest Ebook Central,